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You have agreed to participate in a research study about people's experiences with music. You will have a short online interview with a researcher. The researcher will ask you some questions.

1. Thank you for agreeing to take part in the study. I'd like to ask you some questions about your experiences with music. First, how important is music in your life? Why?

Okay... music is incredibly important in my life. Honestly, it's like a constant companion. I listen to it every day, whether I'm commuting, studying, or just relaxing. It really helps me regulate my mood. For example, if I'm feeling stressed, I'll put on some classical music to calm down. But if I need energy for a workout, I switch to upbeat pop. So, yeah, it's not just background noise; it's a tool that actively shapes my emotions and helps me get through my daily routine.

2. Great. That's interesting. Now, if you had to choose, would you rather create music yourself or listen to music created by others? Why?

Okay... I would definitely rather create music myself. The main reason is that it allows me to express my own emotions and ideas in a unique way. When I play guitar and write songs, I can capture exactly how I'm feeling at that moment, which is incredibly satisfying. Listening to others' music is enjoyable, but it's more passive. Creating music, even simple melodies, gives me a sense of accomplishment and personal connection that I just can't get from being a listener.

3. Okay. Noted. Do you think music should be a required part of children's education? Why or why not?

Well, I strongly believe music should be a required part of children's education. For one thing, it helps develop cognitive skills... like memory and pattern recognition, which are useful in subjects like math. Also, learning an instrument teaches discipline and patience. For example, when I was in school, playing in the band helped me focus better. So, overall, music education supports both academic growth and personal development, making it a valuable requirement.

4. live or recorded music?

Honestly, live music has a much stronger effect on me. The main reason is the atmosphere — there's an energy in a room full of people that a recording just can't reproduce. You can feel the sound physically, not only hear it. For example, when a musician improvises something slightly differently on the night, the piece feels new, and you know you're hearing a version that only exists once. Recorded music is more practical, of course — I listen to it every day in the car. That said, if I had to choose one experience, it would be live. So overall, recorded for daily life, live for the memory.

2

1. Thank you for agreeing to participate. I'd like to ask you some questions about your experiences with setting personal goals. First, think of a time, recent or not, when you had something you wanted to achieve. What was it?

Okay... I'd like to talk about a time when I set a goal to improve my public speaking skills. I wanted to become more confident presenting in front of groups, so I set a specific goal: to give a ten-minute presentation at work without relying on notes. I practiced daily, recording myself and asking for feedback from colleagues. It was challenging at first, but after a few months, I successfully delivered the presentation and felt really proud. Achieving this goal boosted my confidence and showed me the value of consistent effort.

2. Gotcha! In general, how do you handle difficulties or obstacles that come up while working toward what you want to achieve?

Well, generally speaking, I try to break big problems into smaller steps. For example, when I struggled with a difficult research project, I first identified the main issue, then created a daily plan to tackle each part separately. I also ask for help when needed, like discussing ideas with classmates or professors. This approach keeps me from feeling overwhelmed and helps me stay focused on my goal. So, staying organized and seeking support are my key strategies.

3. Understood. In your opinion, how important is goal setting for personal growth?

Well... I believe goal setting is absolutely crucial for personal growth. Without goals, it's easy to drift aimlessly. For example, when I wanted to improve my public speaking, I set a specific goal to give one presentation each month. This gave me clear direction and motivation to practice regularly. Goals also help measure progress, which builds confidence. So, in my view, setting goals provides the structure needed to develop new skills and achieve meaningful self-improvement.

4. Thanks. Last question. Do you think children should be taught to set personal goals from an early age, why, or why not?

Okay... I definitely think children should be taught to set personal goals from an early age. It teaches them responsibility and helps them understand the value of working toward something. For example, when I was young, my parents encouraged me to set small goals like finishing a book each week, and that really built my discipline and confidence. Plus, it prepares them for bigger challenges later in life, like college or a career. So, I believe it's a very valuable habit to start early.

3

You have volunteered for a research study at your university about people's experiences with art and creativity. You will have a short online interview with a researcher. The researcher will ask you some questions.

1. Thank you for your participation. I'd like to learn about your experiences with art and creativity. Do you consider yourself to be a creative person? Why or why not?

Actually, yes, I think I am — though maybe not in one single area. I paint sometimes, I write things occasionally, I play piano, and I cook and bake, and I like trying new dishes and desserts rather than repeating the same recipes. For example, I'll often start a dessert without following the recipe exactly, just to see what happens. I think what all of those have in common is that I enjoy making something that didn't exist before. So overall, I'd say I'm creative in a scattered way — a lot of small outlets rather than one big one.

2. Great. Some people think that learning about art is just as important as learning science or math. Do you agree or disagree? Why?

Okay... I definitely agree that learning about art is just as important as science or math. First of all, art helps develop critical thinking and creativity, which are essential for innovation in any field. For example, many successful engineers and scientists use creative problem-solving skills that come from artistic training. Additionally, art allows us to understand different cultures and express emotions, which builds empathy and communication skills. While science and math are crucial for practical knowledge, a well-rounded education should include art to nurture the whole person. So, I believe both are equally valuable.

3. Interesting. Some people believe that engaging in creative activities can improve mental well-being. Do you agree or disagree? Why?

Okay... I definitely agree that creative activities can improve mental well-being. For me personally, when I paint or write, it gives me a way to express emotions that I can't put into words. This helps reduce stress and clears my mind. Also, focusing on a creative task, like playing an instrument, forces me to be present in the moment, which is really calming. So, creative activities aren't just hobbies... they're actually a powerful tool for maintaining good mental health.

4. Good points. One final question. Do you think future schools will teach more art or less? What factors might influence this?

Okay... I think future schools will actually teach more art. As automation increases, creative thinking becomes more valuable. Employers are looking for innovation and problem-solving skills, which art education directly develops. Also, research shows that art improves academic performance in other subjects. However, budget constraints could limit this if schools face funding cuts. But I believe the growing recognition of art's benefits will outweigh financial concerns, leading to more emphasis on arts education in the future.

4

1. Thank you for agreeing to participate. I'd like to ask you some questions about your thoughts on childhood education. First, did you enjoy your school experience as a child?

Okay, well, actually, I really enjoyed my school experience as a child. I had a wonderful teacher in third grade who made learning fun through hands-on projects, like building a model of the solar system. That positive experience shaped my overall attitude. I also loved recess, because it gave me a chance to play with my friends and just be a kid. So, yes, overall it was a very happy time for me.

2. Thank you. Tell me about a school project or activity you participated in. What made that project or activity special?

Well, I'd like to talk about a school project where we built a small community garden. What made it special was... it wasn't just about planting vegetables. We had to research soil types, plan the layout, and work together as a team. I remember we faced a challenge when the weather turned bad, but we adapted by building a simple shelter. Seeing the first seeds sprout after weeks of effort felt incredibly rewarding. That project taught me practical skills and the value of collaboration, which I still appreciate today.

3. Interesting. Tell me a little about the technology you used during your childhood education. Do you feel like that technology prepared you for life after school? Why or why not?

Well, when I was in elementary school... we used desktop computers with basic educational software. I remember using programs like Math Blaster and typing tutorials. Honestly... I don't think that technology fully prepared me for life after school. The technology I used was quite limited compared to what we have today. For example, we didn't learn about online research or digital collaboration... which are essential in college and the workplace now. So, while it gave me foundational computer skills... it didn't really prepare me for the fast-paced digital world I later encountered.

4. Great. Some people believe that the current education system needs significant changes to better prepare children for the future, focusing more on skills like problem solving and teamwork instead of mainly teaching facts. Do you agree or disagree with this viewpoint? Why?

Okay... I definitely agree with this viewpoint. Our current system puts too much emphasis on memorizing facts, which students can easily look up online. Instead, schools should focus on practical skills like problem-solving and teamwork. For example, in my own experience, group projects taught me how to collaborate effectively and think critically, which are essential in today's workplace. These skills help children adapt to future challenges, while facts often become outdated. So yes, shifting the focus to these abilities would better prepare students for real-world success.

You have volunteered for a research study about grocery shopping habits. You will have a short online interview with a researcher. The researcher will ask you some questions.

1. Thank you for taking part in our study. I'd like to ask you some questions about your grocery shopping habits. First, how often do you go grocery shopping each week? Why that often?

Well... I usually go grocery shopping once a week, typically on Saturdays. I find that this schedule works best for me because it allows me to plan my meals for the entire week ahead. Also, shopping weekly helps me avoid wasting food since I buy only what I need for seven days. If I shopped more frequently, I'd probably end up buying unnecessary items, and less often would mean my fresh produce wouldn't stay good. So once a week keeps things balanced and efficient for my lifestyle.

2. Great, thank you. Can you tell me what types of items you usually buy when you go grocery shopping? For example, do you buy fresh produce, dairy products or packaged foods?

Okay... well, when I go grocery shopping, I usually buy a mix of things. I focus a lot on fresh produce like vegetables and fruits... especially leafy greens and berries. I also get dairy products such as milk and yogurt. But I do buy some packaged foods too, like pasta and canned beans, for quick meals. So it's really a balance between fresh items and a few staples.

3. Got it. When you are grocery shopping, how often do you impulse buy? In other words, buy things you did not plan on buying. What types of items do you or might you impulse buy?

Well, to be honest, I impulse buy quite often when grocery shopping... probably once every two trips. I usually grab snacks or drinks I didn't plan for, like a new flavor of chips or a fancy soda. Sometimes it's fresh produce that looks really good, like ripe mangoes or strawberries. I think it's because the store displays are so tempting, and I'm curious to try new things. So yeah, snacks and seasonal fruits are my main impulse buys.

4. Great, that's helpful. Last question, some people believe that shopping at local farmers markets is better than shopping at large grocery stores. Do you agree or disagree with this opinion? Why?

Okay... I definitely agree that shopping at local farmers markets is better. First, the produce is much fresher since it's picked recently and hasn't traveled far. This means better taste and more nutrients. Also, I love supporting local farmers directly, it helps the community's economy rather than big corporations. Finally, farmers markets have a friendly atmosphere where you can actually talk to the people who grow your food. So for freshness, community support, and a pleasant experience, local markets are clearly the better choice.

You have signed up for a study run by a university research group that is investigating people's experiences with books and reading. You will have a short online interview with a researcher. The researcher will ask you some questions.

1. Thank you for your participation. I'd like to learn about your experiences with books and reading. Was there a time in your life when you read more or less than you do now? What changed?

Okay, well, definitely yes. When I was in high school, I read a lot more than I do now. I was always reading novels for English class, you know, and I actually enjoyed it. But then, I started college and my schedule just got packed. Now, I mostly read textbooks and articles for my major. I barely have time for pleasure reading anymore. So, the main change is just having a lot less free time due to my academic workload.

2. Great. In your opinion, is reading for pleasure a popular way people spend their free time where you live. Why do you think that is?

Well, actually... I don't think reading for pleasure is very popular where I live. Most people I know prefer watching TV shows or scrolling through social media instead. I think the main reason is that reading requires more focus and time, which people feel they don't have after a busy day. Also, with smartphones and streaming services, it's just so easy to access quick entertainment. However, I do see some people reading e-books on their commute, so it's not completely absent, but definitely not the first choice for free time.

3. Interesting. Do you think reading different types of books helps people understand each other and get along better? Why or why not?

Well, absolutely... I believe reading different types of books really helps people understand each other and get along better. For one thing, when you read fiction from another culture, you step into someone else's shoes and see the world through their eyes. This builds empathy, which is key to resolving conflicts. Also, reading nonfiction about history or social issues gives you insight into why people think differently. So, it broadens your perspective and makes you more open-minded... and that naturally leads to better relationships

4. Good points. I just have one more question. Looking ahead, some people believe that future generations will read less than today's generation. Do you agree or disagree? Why?

Well, I actually disagree with that idea. I think future generations might read even more, but in different formats. For example, with audiobooks and podcasts becoming so popular, people are consuming stories and information constantly, even while commuting or exercising. Also, digital platforms like e-readers make books more accessible than ever. So, while traditional print reading might decline, overall reading habits could increase because content is everywhere and easier to access.

1. Thank you for agreeing to participate. I'd like to ask you some questions about your online shopping habits. First, how often do you shop online? Do you do it weekly, monthly or less often?

Well, I'd say I shop online about once a month. Actually, I prefer to make one larger purchase rather than ordering frequently. For example, last month I bought a few books and some household items together to save on shipping costs. I find it more convenient than going to the store, especially since I can compare prices easily. So yeah, monthly works best for me.

2. Thank you. If you were to shop online, what types of products would you be most likely to buy? For example, would you buy clothing, electronics, or groceries?

Well, actually, I'd be most likely to buy electronics online. That's because, unlike clothing or groceries, I don't need to try them on or check freshness. For example, when I bought my laptop, I just compared specs and reviews online, which was super convenient. Also, electronics often have better deals and a wider selection online than in physical stores. So yeah, electronics would definitely be my top choice for online shopping.

3. Interesting. Some people believe that online shopping is more convenient than shopping in physical stores, while others think it's a worse experience because it lacks the human interaction of in-person shopping. What is your opinion on this?

Well... I definitely think online shopping is more convenient, actually. For me, the main advantage is saving time and energy. I can browse products from home, compare prices instantly, and avoid traffic or long checkout lines. For example, last week I needed a new textbook... and I found it online in just five minutes. In a store, I would have had to drive to multiple locations. So while I understand missing human interaction... that personal touch isn't essential for routine purchases. The convenience of shopping anytime, anywhere really outweighs that for me.

4. Some people believe physical stores might one day disappear because of online shopping. What is your opinion on this? Why?

Well, I disagree that physical stores will completely disappear. While online shopping is convenient, I believe physical stores offer unique experiences that can't be replicated online. For instance, customers can try on clothes to check fit and quality, or see furniture colors in person. Also, many people enjoy the social aspect of shopping with friends or family. So, I think physical stores will adapt by focusing on experiences and personalized services, but they won't vanish entirely.

You received an email from your university inviting you to join a research study about holiday celebrations. You have scheduled a short online interview with a researcher to answer a few questions.

1. Thank you for agreeing to participate. I'd like to ask you some questions about holiday celebrations. First, do you celebrate holidays with your family, friends, or both? How often do you participate with them?

Okay... I celebrate holidays with both my family and friends, actually. For major holidays like Thanksgiving and Christmas, I always spend them with my immediate family. We have a big dinner together and exchange gifts. But for New Year's Eve, I usually celebrate with my friends. We go out to watch fireworks or have a small party. So I participate in holiday celebrations pretty often, maybe once or twice a month during the holiday season. It's a great way to stay connected with everyone.

2. Thank you. Can you describe one of your favorite holiday celebrations or festivals? What do you do to mark the occasion?

Okay... one of my favorite holiday celebrations is Thanksgiving. I really enjoy it because it's all about family and gratitude. We usually gather at my grandparents' house, and everyone brings a dish to share. My aunt makes the best mashed potatoes, and I always help with the pumpkin pie. During the day, we eat a big meal together, then we go around the table and say what we're thankful for. It's a warm, relaxing time, and it reminds me to appreciate the people in my life.

3. Interesting. Tell me about a special event that was particularly memorable for you. What made it meaningful?

Well, for me... the most memorable event was my high school graduation. It was special because I was the first in my family to graduate, and seeing my parents in the crowd... crying with pride... that really hit me. The ceremony itself was wonderful, but what made it meaningful was all the struggle behind it. My family sacrificed so much for my education, and that moment felt like a shared victory. It reminded me that hard work pays off and that I have a strong support system behind me.

4. Great. Some people believe that traditional cultural observances are becoming less important in modern society. Do you agree or disagree with this viewpoint? Why?

Well... I actually disagree with that viewpoint. Traditional cultural observances are still very important in modern society. For example, many young people today actively participate in festivals like Lunar New Year or Thanksgiving, which strengthen family bonds and preserve heritage. Also, these traditions provide a sense of identity and continuity in our fast-changing world. They remind us of our roots and values, so I believe they remain deeply meaningful, even as society evolves.

You received an email from your university inviting you to join a research study about entertainment preferences. You have scheduled a short online interview with a researcher to answer a few questions.

1. Thank you for your participation today. I'd like to ask you some questions about your entertainment preferences. What kind of movies do your family or friends generally like to watch? For example, do they prefer action movies, comedies, dramas, or other types?

Well, actually, my family and friends have pretty different tastes. My parents really enjoy dramas, especially those with deep emotional stories like family sagas. They find them touching and relatable. On the other hand, my friends are huge fans of action movies, you know, the ones with thrilling chase scenes and special effects. I personally like comedies because they help me relax after a long day. So, it really varies, but we all try to compromise when watching together.

2. I see. When you watch a movie, do you prefer to watch after work or school on weekdays, or do you like to watch during the weekends? Why?

Well, I definitely prefer watching movies on weekends rather than weekdays. After work or school, I'm usually pretty exhausted, you know, and I don't have the mental energy to focus on a full film. On weekends though, I have plenty of free time, so I can really relax and enjoy the experience without rushing. Plus, I can stay up late if it's a long movie, and I don't have to worry about getting up early the next day. So weekends just feel much more comfortable for me.

3. Interesting. Next, I'd like to get your opinion. In the past, people mostly watched movies in theaters. Today many people watch movies at home. Do you think that movie theaters will continue to exist in the future? Why or why not?

Well, I definitely believe movie theaters will continue to exist in the future. Even though home streaming is incredibly convenient, theaters offer a unique experience you can't replicate at home. For example, the huge screen and powerful sound system create an immersive atmosphere that's perfect for big blockbuster films. Also, it's a social event. People enjoy going out with friends or family, grabbing popcorn, and watching a movie together. So, while home viewing is popular, theaters provide that special communal experience... and I think that will keep them alive.

4. Good points. I just have one more question. Some people believe that movies can be a powerful tool for educating people and raising awareness about important issues. Do you agree with this idea or do you think there are other more effective ways to educate people? Explain why you think so.

Well... I definitely agree that movies can be a powerful educational tool. For example, documentaries like "An Inconvenient Truth" really raised global awareness about climate change in a way that textbooks simply can't. The visual storytelling and emotional connection make complex issues accessible and memorable. However, I think movies work best when combined with other methods like discussions or hands-on activities. So while films are effective for sparking interest and awareness, they shouldn't replace deeper learning approaches.

You have signed up for a study run by a university research group that is investigating shopping habits. You will have a short video interview with one of the researchers. The researcher will ask you some questions.

1. Thank you for taking the time to speak with me. I'd like to ask you some questions about your shopping habits. When was your last shopping trip? And what did you buy? Did you have a good shopping experience?

Well, actually my last shopping trip was just last weekend. I went to a local grocery store to pick up some essentials for the week. I bought fresh vegetables, like broccoli and spinach, along with some chicken and rice. The experience was pretty good overall. The store wasn't too crowded, which I appreciated, and I found everything I needed quickly. The only small issue was a long line at the checkout, but it moved fairly fast. So yeah, it was a smooth and convenient trip.

2. I see. When you shop, which do you like better shopping for yourself or shopping for others? Why?

Okay... I definitely prefer shopping for others, not for myself. The main reason is, I find it much more enjoyable to see someone else's face light up when they receive a gift I picked out. For example, last month I spent hours choosing a book for my best friend. I thought about her interests and what would make her happy. When she opened it and smiled, that feeling was way better than buying myself a new shirt. So for me, the joy comes from making others feel special.

3. Interesting. Next, I'd like to get your opinion. In recent years, people's shopping preferences have shifted in various ways. Do you think that in the future, people will continue to change how and where they shop? Why? Or why not?

Well, I definitely think people will keep changing how and where they shop. For one thing, technology is always evolving, so we'll see more online shopping with virtual try-ons and faster delivery options. Also, people care more about sustainability now, so they might choose local stores or brands that use eco-friendly packaging. These shifts make shopping more convenient and aligned with personal values. So, yes, shopping habits will continue evolving.

4. Good points. I just have one more question. Some people believe that buying too many products you do not need harms the environment. Do you agree with this idea? Why or why not?

Okay... I definitely agree with that idea. When we buy too many unnecessary products, it creates more waste and pollution. For example, cheap plastic items often end up in landfills, and manufacturing them uses a lot of energy and resources. I think this is a serious problem because it contributes to climate change and environmental damage. So, it's important to be more mindful about our purchases and only buy what we really need.

As part of a university project, you have agreed to take part in an interview about personal goals and achievements. A graduate student conducting the research will ask you some questions online.

1. Thank you for agreeing to participate. I'd like to ask you some questions about your personal goals and achievements. First, do you currently have any specific personal goals you are working towards? Give details to explain your answer.

Well, sure... I do have a specific personal goal I'm working towards right now. Actually, I'm training to run a half marathon in about three months. I've always enjoyed running, but never at this distance. So, I follow a structured plan... gradually increasing my mileage each week. For example, last week I ran eight miles, which felt great. My main motivation is to challenge myself physically and build discipline, since I tend to procrastinate on long-term tasks. Achieving this goal would really boost my confidence.

2. Thank you. Can you describe some steps you can take to achieve these goals, or to achieve goals in general? What are the challenges you face when taking these steps?

Well, I think the first step is to break down a big goal into smaller, manageable tasks. For example, if I want to improve my English, I'll set weekly targets like learning ten new words a day. Then, I create a schedule and track my progress regularly. The main challenge I face is staying consistent, especially when I'm busy or tired. Sometimes I get discouraged if I don't see quick results. To overcome this, I remind myself of the bigger picture and adjust my plan if needed.

3. Interesting, can you describe an accomplishment that holds special meaning for you? What did you achieve and why is it significant to you?

Well... an accomplishment that really means a lot to me is learning to play the guitar on my own. I started from scratch, using online tutorials and practicing every day for about a year. Finally, I was able to play a full song in front of my family. It's significant because it taught me patience and discipline. I'm not naturally musical, so proving to myself that I could master something difficult through consistent effort gave me a huge confidence boost. It reminds me that I can achieve anything if I stick with it.

4. Great, some people believe that setting and working towards individual goals is crucial for self-improvement and personal growth. Do you agree or disagree with this idea? Why?

Well, I absolutely agree with this idea. Setting individual goals gives us a clear direction and motivation to improve ourselves. For example, when I aimed to run a 5K race, I created a weekly training schedule. This helped me track my progress and stay committed, even on days I felt lazy. Without that goal, I might have given up easily. Goals also build discipline and confidence as we achieve them step by step. So, yes, they are crucial for personal growth.

1. You have volunteered for a research study at your university about exercise programs. You will have a short online interview with a researcher. The researcher will ask you some questions.

Sample 1:

Okay... I definitely think exercising daily is important for good health. Regular physical activity, like a brisk walk or some stretching, really helps maintain cardiovascular fitness and strengthen muscles. It also boosts mental well-being by reducing stress and improving mood. Even moderate exercise, done consistently, can prevent chronic conditions like heart disease. So yes, I believe daily movement is essential for a healthy lifestyle.

Sample 2:

Sure, I strongly believe that exercising daily is crucial for good health. First, it helps prevent weight gain and reduces the risk of conditions like high blood pressure and diabetes. Second, regular exercise boosts your mood and energy levels, so you feel better throughout the day. Additionally, it strengthens your cardiovascular system and improves sleep quality. In my personal experience, even a thirty-minute walk each morning gives me more focus. So, I think daily exercise is essential for overall well-being. Without a doubt, it's one of the best habits you can develop.

2. Thank you. Imagine you are going to recommend or create an exercise program for a friend or family member who does not currently exercise. What kind of exercise or fitness routine would you recommend? Why?

Sample 1:

Sure, for a friend who doesn't exercise, I'd recommend starting with a simple walking routine. It's low-impact, requires no equipment, and can be done almost anywhere. I'd suggest a daily twenty-minute walk at a comfortable pace. This builds cardiovascular health gradually without being intimidating. Additionally, I'd include basic bodyweight exercises like squats and push-ups twice a week to build strength. The key is consistency and enjoyment, so they're more likely to stick with it. This approach helps prevent injury while improving overall fitness.

Sample 2:

Well, sure... I'd recommend a walking routine for someone who doesn't exercise. Walking is low-impact, easy on the joints, and requires no equipment. I'd suggest starting with just fifteen minutes a day, at a comfortable pace, then gradually increasing duration. This builds confidence and makes exercise a habit. It improves cardiovascular health and mood without being intimidating. The key is to keep it simple and sustainable.

3. Interesting. For that same friend or family member, what do you think might challenge them the most about a regular exercise program? How would you help them through this challenge?

Okay, so for my friend, I think the biggest challenge would be staying motivated, especially after a long workday. They get discouraged easily if they don't see quick results. To help them, I'd suggest starting with very short, enjoyable workouts, like a fifteen-minute walk or dance session. I'd also join them regularly, so it feels social and accountable. Celebrating small achievements, like completing a week, would keep them going.

4. Great, some people believe that it is important to have some sort of reward after a good week of exercising. What do you think would be a good reward for the program you created, and why?

Sample 1:

Okay, sure... for the exercise program I created, which focuses on a mix of cardio and strength training, I think a good reward would be a relaxing massage. The reason is... it directly supports the program's goal of recovery and injury prevention. After a week of intense workouts, muscles need care, and a massage helps relieve tension. This not only feels great... but also encourages me to stick with the program, knowing I have that reward at the end of the week.

Sample 2:

Well, for the exercise program I described, I think a relaxing massage would be a perfect reward. I mean, after a week of consistent workouts, my muscles would be tired and sore. A massage isn't something I'd do every day, so it feels like a real treat. More importantly, it directly supports my fitness goals by improving recovery and reducing stiffness. So, it's not just an indulgence... it's a practical way to acknowledge my hard work and stay motivated.

The Older Exams

1

You have volunteered for a research study about people's experiences with social gatherings. You will have a short online interview with a researcher. The researcher will ask you some questions.

1. Thank you for being part of the study. I'd like to ask you some questions about your experiences with social gatherings. First, do you enjoy attending large social gatherings, or do you prefer smaller, more private gatherings? Why is that?

Well, I definitely prefer smaller, more private gatherings. I find them much more comfortable and meaningful. In a small group, I can have real conversations and actually connect with people. For instance, at a dinner party with close friends, we can talk about our lives and share stories. But at large parties, it's often too noisy and crowded to have a proper conversation. I also feel less social pressure in a small setting, which helps me relax and enjoy myself more. Overall, smaller gatherings feel more genuine to me.

2. Thank you. Can you describe a memorable social gathering you attended recently? What made it special?

Well, I recently attended my cousin's wedding reception, and it was truly memorable. What made it special was the warm family reunion... we hadn't all been together for years. I especially enjoyed the live band playing classic songs, which got everyone dancing. The highlight, though, was when my uncle gave a heartfelt speech about our family history. It created such a joyful, connected atmosphere. Honestly, that sense of togetherness made the evening unforgettable.

3. Very good. How do you usually prepare for a social gathering? What do you focus on most?

Well, I usually focus on making sure I'm comfortable and prepared to connect with others. For me, the most important thing is having a few conversation topics in mind... like recent news or shared interests. I also pay attention to my outfit... picking something appropriate but not too formal. That way, I feel relaxed and can genuinely engage with people. Honestly, being mentally ready matters more than anything else, because it helps me enjoy the gathering and build meaningful connections naturally.

4. Some people believe that social gatherings are important opportunities for building and maintaining professional relationships. Do you agree or disagree with this idea? Why or why not?

Well, I definitely agree with this idea. Social gatherings, like networking events or casual dinners, create a relaxed environment where people can connect on a personal level, not just through formal meetings. For example, I once met a key client at a company party, and chatting informally built trust faster than any email exchange could. These interactions help you understand colleagues' personalities and interests, which strengthens collaboration later. In my experience, these genuine connections often lead to better opportunities and long-term partnerships, making social events essential for career growth.

2

You are participating in a research study conducted by your university's Department of Environmental Science about environmental practices. You will meet online with a researcher who will ask you some questions.

1. Thank you for agreeing to participate. I'd like to ask you some questions about your environmental practices. First, do you take any specific actions to reduce your environmental impact, such as recycling or conserving energy? Give details in your answer.

Well, sure... I do take several actions to reduce my environmental impact. Actually, I make a conscious effort to recycle regularly... I separate paper, plastic, and glass at home, and I always check local guidelines. Also, I conserve energy by turning off lights and electronics when they're not in use, and I use a programmable thermostat to reduce heating at night. These small habits really add up... and they help me feel like I'm contributing to a healthier planet.

2. Thank you. Can you describe one or two steps your community or neighborhood takes to be environmentally friendly? For example, are there solar panels on buildings or rainwater barrels available where you live?

Okay... well, in my neighborhood we have a community composting program. Every household gets a small bin for food scraps, and then once a week they're collected and turned into fertilizer for local parks. Also, many homes have installed rain barrels to collect water for their gardens, which really helps during dry spells. It's great because it reduces waste and saves water at the same time.

3. Interesting. If you had the chance to participate in an ecological or nature-based activity, such as a community cleanup effort or tree planting event, what would you do and why?

Okay, I'd definitely choose a community tree planting event. Actually, I find it more impactful because trees provide long-term environmental benefits. For example, they absorb carbon dioxide, produce oxygen, and help prevent soil erosion. Also, planting trees creates a lasting legacy... you can watch them grow over the years, which is really rewarding. A cleanup effort is great too, but it's more of a temporary fix. So, yeah, tree planting offers a more sustainable, long-lasting contribution to the local ecosystem.

4. Great! Some people believe that individual actions are not enough to address conservation issues, and that significant changes must come from government policies. Do you agree or disagree with this viewpoint? Why or why not?

Well, I actually disagree with that viewpoint. While government policies are certainly important, I believe individual actions can make a significant difference. For example, when millions of people choose to reduce plastic use or recycle properly, that collective behavior creates real environmental impact. Also, individual actions often inspire broader change. When people see their neighbors installing solar panels or driving electric cars, it creates social pressure for communities to adopt greener practices. So I think both individual efforts and government policies are necessary working together for conservation.

3

You have volunteered for a research study about people's experiences with friendship. You will have a short online interview with a researcher. The researcher will ask you some questions.

1. Thank you for signing up for the study. I'd like to ask you some questions about your experiences with friendship. First do you have a large group of friends or do you prefer to have a smaller group of friends?

Well, I definitely prefer having a smaller group of friends. I have about three or four really close friends, and that works best for me. With a small group, I can build deeper connections and really trust them. We share personal experiences and support each other through tough times. For example, my best friend and I have known each other for over ten years. Having a large group feels overwhelming to me, and it's harder to maintain that level of closeness. So yeah, quality over quantity is my approach.

2. Very good. Now describe a time when a friendship taught you something valuable or helped you see something from a new perspective.

Okay... a friendship that really taught me something valuable was with my college roommate. I used to be very focused on my own goals, but she was incredibly community-minded. One semester, she dragged me to volunteer at a local shelter. At first I saw it as a chore... but seeing her genuine connection with everyone there was eye-opening. She taught me that success isn't just personal achievement... it's also about lifting others up. That experience completely shifted my perspective on what truly matters in life.

3. Great. Next question. In your opinion what makes a friendship last a long time?

Well... I believe that trust and open communication are the key factors that make a friendship last a long time. For example, when friends can honestly share their feelings without fear of judgment, it builds a strong foundation. Also, being there for each other during difficult moments, like offering support during a tough breakup or health issue, really deepens the bond. In my experience, friends who respect each other's boundaries and make time for regular catch-ups tend to stay close for years. So, it's really about mutual effort and understanding.

4. OK last one. Some people believe that maintaining friendships is essential for emotional well-being and life satisfaction. Do you agree or disagree with this viewpoint. Why? or Why not?

Okay... I definitely agree with that viewpoint. Maintaining friendships is crucial for emotional well-being because friends provide support during tough times. For instance, when I faced a stressful exam period, my friends encouraged me and helped me relax. That connection boosted my mood and reduced anxiety. Also, friendships give us a sense of belonging, which increases life satisfaction. Without close friends, people can feel lonely and isolated, which harms their mental health. So, yes, I believe friendships are essential for a happy, balanced life.

4

You have volunteered for a research study about people's experiences with financial planning. You will have a short online interview with a researcher. The researcher will ask you some questions.

1. Thank you for joining us today to help with the study. I'd like to ask you some questions about your experiences with financial planning. First, do you currently have a financial plan or budget that you follow?

Okay... yes, I do have a financial plan that I follow. I use a simple monthly budget to track my income and expenses, which helps me avoid overspending. For example, I allocate a fixed amount for essentials like rent and groceries, and I set aside a portion for savings. This approach keeps me organized and reduces financial stress. I've been doing it for about two years now, and it's really helped me stay on top of my goals.

2. Thank you. If you could design the ideal way of managing your money, what would it look like?

Okay... if I could design the ideal way to manage my money, I'd focus on simplicity and automation. I'd have a single checking account for daily expenses, and then automatically transfer a fixed percentage of my income into separate savings and investment accounts each month. Also, I'd use a simple budgeting app that tracks everything in real time, so I can see exactly where my money is going without any hassle. This way, I'd avoid overspending and build savings effortlessly, without having to think about it too much.

3. I see. In your opinion, what are the most common obstacles people run into with financial planning?

Well, I think one major obstacle is unexpected expenses... like medical emergencies or car repairs that throw off even the best budget. Another common issue is lack of discipline... people might start strong but then give in to impulse spending on things like dining out or new gadgets. Also, many people don't have a clear goal... they save without a specific target, which makes it hard to stay motivated. So, really, it's a mix of surprises, self-control, and planning that trips people up.

4. People believe that detailed financial planning is crucial for achieving long-term financial stability and goals. Do you agree or disagree with this belief? Why or why not?

Well, I definitely agree that detailed financial planning is crucial for long-term stability. See, without a clear plan, it's easy to overspend or lose track of savings goals. For example, creating a monthly budget and setting aside funds for emergencies helped me avoid debt when my car broke down unexpectedly. Also, planning for retirement early means you can take advantage of compound interest over time. So, having a structured approach really ensures you're prepared for both expected and unexpected expenses, which builds lasting financial security.

5

You received an email from your university inviting you to join a research study about social media. You have scheduled a short online interview with a researcher to answer a few questions.

1. Thanks so much for joining us today. I'd like to ask you a few questions about social media. To start, how often do you use social media platforms? and for what purposes? Or if you don't use them, why not?

Okay, well... I use social media pretty much every day, mainly for staying in touch with friends and family. I check Instagram and WhatsApp a few times daily to see updates or send quick messages. Also, I use YouTube for educational content, like watching tutorials for my classes. So, it's mostly for communication and learning. I don't spend hours scrolling though, just short periods throughout the day.

2. Great. Next question. In your opinion, what makes social media either enjoyable or difficult to deal with?

Well... for me, social media is both enjoyable and difficult. On the one hand, it's enjoyable because it helps me stay connected with friends and family who live far away. I can see their photos and share updates instantly. On the other hand, it's difficult because of the constant pressure to compare myself to others. Everyone seems to be living a perfect life, and that can be stressful. So, while it's great for connection, it also creates anxiety sometimes.

3. Ok now what kinds of things do you think are appropriate to share on social media? And why?

Well, I think it's appropriate to share personal achievements and positive experiences on social media... like graduating from college or traveling to a new place. These posts inspire others and strengthen connections with friends. Also, sharing useful information, such as health tips or community events, is good because it benefits followers. However, I believe private matters, like family conflicts or embarrassing moments, should be avoided... since they can harm relationships or cause regret. Basically, content that's uplifting and respectful is most suitable for social sharing.

4. Understood. And finally some people believe that social media has more negative effects than positive ones on society in general. Do you agree or disagree with this viewpoint? Explain why?

Okay, actually, I disagree with that viewpoint. I believe social media has more positive effects overall. For instance, it connects people across the globe, allowing families and friends to stay in touch easily. Also, it's a powerful tool for raising awareness about important social issues, like environmental campaigns or fundraising for disasters. Sure, there are negatives like misinformation, but the benefits of instant communication and community building are more significant in my opinion.

6

You have volunteered for a research study at your university about people's experiences with home decoration. You will have a short online interview with a researcher. The researcher will ask you some questions.

1. Thanks for participating in this study. I'd like to ask you some questions about your experiences with home decoration. First, do you enjoy decorating your living space? or do you find it challenging? Why do you think that is?

Well, I actually really enjoy decorating my living space. For me, it's a creative outlet that lets me express my personality. I find it relaxing to choose colors and arrange furniture in a way that feels cozy and functional. For example, I love adding plants and artwork to make the room feel more alive. I think the reason I enjoy it is because I see it as a fun challenge rather than a chore. It's satisfying to see a space transform into something that truly reflects who I am.

2. Interesting. Thank you. Can you describe a recent home decoration project you or someone you know worked on? And what changes were made?

Well, sure... my sister recently redecorated her living room. She wanted it to feel more open and modern. The biggest change was removing an old bulky bookcase and replacing it with a sleek, wall-mounted media unit. She also painted the walls a soft, light gray instead of the dark beige. And she added a large, round mirror to reflect light. Honestly, the room feels twice as big now and much more relaxing. She's really happy with how it turned out.

3. OK. What kinds of living spaces do you find inviting or comfortable? Why do you think that is?

Well, for me... I find cozy, well-lit living spaces most inviting. I really like rooms with lots of natural light during the day and warm, soft lighting at night. Also, I prefer open floor plans because they feel more spacious and allow me to move around freely. I think this is because such spaces make me feel relaxed and less confined. For example, my apartment has large windows and a combined living and dining area, and I always feel at ease there. So for me, comfort comes from a balance of light and openness.

4. Some people believe that a well-decorated living space can significantly improve one's mood and productivity. Do you agree or disagree with this viewpoint? Why? Or why not?

Okay, I definitely agree with this viewpoint. Personally, having a well-decorated living space makes me feel more relaxed and focused. For instance, I have a small desk with a plant and good lighting, and that simple setup helps me concentrate on my work much better. A cluttered or dull room, on the other hand, makes me feel distracted and unmotivated. So, I think a pleasant environment directly boosts both mood and productivity.

You have signed up for a study run by a university research group that is investigating education experiences. You will have a short video interview with one of the researchers. The researcher will ask you some questions.

1. Thank you for joining the study. Today, I'd like to ask you some questions about your education experiences. First, which do you think is more important for a college? Offering a wide variety of courses or having small class sizes? Why?

Well, I think small class sizes are more important for a college. In my own experience, smaller classes allow for more interaction with professors and deeper discussions. For example, in my freshman year, I took a seminar with only fifteen students, and I felt comfortable asking questions and sharing ideas. That really helped me understand the material better. In contrast, large lectures can feel impersonal, and students might not get the attention they need. So, while variety is nice, small classes create a better learning environment.

2. I see. Imagine that you are preparing for a test, would you prefer to study by yourself or group? What would make you choose one over the other?

Well, I definitely prefer studying by myself when preparing for a test. The main reason is that I can control my own pace and focus entirely on my weak areas without any distractions. For example, if I'm struggling with vocabulary, I can spend extra time memorizing words instead of following a group's schedule. Also, studying alone allows me to create a quiet environment where I can concentrate better. In groups, people often chat or go off-topic, which wastes valuable study time. So, for efficiency and personal focus, I'd choose solo study.

3. Interesting. Some people believe that online courses offer more flexibility and accessibility compared to those offered in usual classroom settings, and are therefore superior. What are your thoughts on this? Do you agree or disagree? Why?

Well, I actually disagree that online courses are inherently superior. While they do offer flexibility in terms of scheduling and location, traditional classrooms provide irreplaceable benefits. For example, face-to-face interaction with professors and classmates allows for immediate feedback and deeper discussions. Also, the structured environment of a physical classroom helps many students stay focused and motivated. So, I believe both formats have strengths, and the best choice really depends on the individual's learning style and goals.

4. Good points. Online courses are becoming increasingly popular and there are now full degree programs offered by universities where every class is available online only. Do you think online learning will someday completely replace in-person learning? Explain your thoughts.

Well, I don't think online learning will completely replace in-person learning. While online courses offer flexibility and accessibility, the classroom experience provides valuable face-to-face interaction and immediate feedback. For example, in group discussions and lab work, students benefit from real-time collaboration and non-verbal cues. Also, some subjects like medicine or engineering require hands-on practice. So, I believe both formats will coexist, but in-person learning will remain essential for certain fields and social development.

8

You have agreed to participate in a research study about people's experiences with learning new hobbies. You will have a short online interview with a researcher. The researcher will ask you some questions.

1. Thanks for being involved in this research. I'd like to ask you some questions about learning new hobbies. First what kinds of hobbies do your friends and family have?

Okay... let me think. Well, my friends and family have quite a variety of hobbies actually. My mom really enjoys gardening and she spends hours in her flower beds every weekend. My dad is into woodworking, he builds furniture and small decorative items. As for my friends, some of them are really into fitness like running and yoga, while others prefer creative hobbies like painting or playing musical instruments. My best friend for example, she loves photography and takes amazing landscape photos during her travels. So yeah, it's a pretty mixed bunch.

2. Thanks for that. Now if your school or workplace organized after-work hobby clubs, which clubs do you think would interest the most people?

Well... I think cooking clubs would interest the most people. Everyone needs to eat, right? And with busy schedules, many people don't have time to learn new recipes. A cooking club would let them try different cuisines in a relaxed setting after work. Also, fitness clubs like yoga or running groups would be popular. A lot of people want to stay healthy but struggle to exercise alone. Having a group makes it more motivating and fun. So yeah, cooking and fitness clubs would definitely attract the largest number of people.

3. Great! That's helpful. Next, do you think hobbies should mostly be relaxing? or is it better if they challenge you? Why?

Well actually... I believe hobbies should strike a balance between relaxation and challenge. For me personally... activities that are too relaxing can become boring over time. But on the other hand... hobbies that are too challenging can feel like work. So I think the best hobbies offer both. For example... I enjoy learning to play the guitar. It's relaxing because I enjoy the music... but it also challenges me to learn new chords and techniques. This combination keeps me engaged and motivated... without causing stress. So a mix of relaxation and challenge is ideal.

4. Got it. Last question. How important do you think it is for people to keep exploring new hobbies as they grow older? Why?

Well... I think it's really important for people to keep exploring new hobbies as they grow older. For one thing, it keeps the mind active and engaged, which is crucial for mental health. For example, my grandfather took up painting in his seventies, and it gave him a whole new sense of purpose and joy. Also, trying new activities helps older adults stay socially connected, since they can join classes or groups. So overall, it combats loneliness and promotes a more fulfilling life.

You have volunteered for a research study at your university about sports participation. You will have a short online interview with a researcher. The researcher will ask you some questions.

1. Thank you for agreeing to participate. I'd like to ask you some questions about your participation in sports. First, do you currently play any sports or engage regularly in any physical activities?

Well, actually... I do. I play tennis regularly, about three times a week with a friend. It's a great way to stay active and clear my mind after work. I also enjoy jogging on weekends, just a light run in the park near my home. It helps me relax and keep fit. So yes, I'd say I'm fairly consistent with these activities.

2. Thank you. If you were able to, what sport that you do not currently play, would you like to be really good at? Why that particular sport?

Sample 1: If I could master one sport, I'd definitely go with chess. Actually, I was pretty into it back in high school—I had a real knack for the strategy behind it. I haven't picked up a board in years, but if I had the time, I'd love to get back into it. The thing is, unlike most sports that rely on physical stamina, chess is really all about mental agility. I find that incredibly appealing. I think jumping back into chess would really help me sharpen my problem-solving skills and, honestly, it's a great way to practice patience. It's more of a mental workout than anything else, and I think that's exactly the kind of challenge I'm looking for right now.

Sample 2: Well, I'd really like to be good at tennis. I think it's such an elegant and fast-paced sport... and it requires both physical strength and mental strategy. I've always admired how players have to think quickly, like where to place the ball next. Also, it's a great full-body workout... and you can play it for a lifetime, even as you get older. So yeah, tennis would be my top choice.

3. Interesting. Tell me about an experience you had while playing a sport or engaging in a physical activity that you remember well.

Okay... I remember this one time during a basketball game in high school. I was really nervous because it was the championship. With just seconds left, the score was tied. I got the ball, and honestly, I felt this huge pressure. But I took a deep breath, focused, and made the winning shot. The crowd went wild. That experience taught me the importance of staying calm under pressure. It wasn't just about winning... it was about trusting my skills when it mattered most.

4. Great. Some people believe that children should not participate in contact sports like rugby or hockey because they could get hurt, while others believe that these sports teach awareness and teamwork. What do you think, and why?

Okay... I believe children should participate in contact sports like rugby... despite the risk of injury. For me, the benefits outweigh the dangers. These sports teach valuable awareness... like how to protect oneself and read opponents' movements. More importantly, teamwork is developed in a very direct way... because players must communicate and trust each other under pressure. While injuries can happen... proper coaching and safety gear can minimize that risk. So, I think the life lessons gained... are far more important than avoiding potential bumps and bruises.

You have agreed to participate in a research study about people's experiences with job satisfaction. You will have a short online interview with a researcher. The researcher will ask you some questions.

1. Thank you for helping with our study. I'd like to ask you some questions about your job satisfaction. First, what do you think are the most important things to consider when looking for a job?

Well, I think the most important thing to consider is whether the job aligns with your personal interests and skills. If you're passionate about what you do, you're more likely to stay motivated and satisfied. Another key factor is work-life balance, like flexible hours or reasonable commute. Also, opportunities for growth matter a lot. For example, if a company offers training or promotions, you can build a long-term career there. So, I'd say interest, balance, and growth are essential.

2. Got it. That's helpful. Now, can you describe a job that either you or one of your friends has had? What kind of work was involved?

Okay... I'd like to describe my friend's job as a barista at a local coffee shop. The main work involved making espresso-based drinks, like lattes and cappuccinos, and also handling customer orders at the register. Beyond that, she had to keep the work area clean, restock supplies, and sometimes manage the rush during morning hours. What I found interesting was how she had to multitask quickly while still being friendly with customers. It really taught her time management and communication skills, and she often said it was challenging but rewarding.

3. Noted. Moving on, what kinds of things do you think can lead people to feel unhappy in their work? Can you tell me about one or two of them?

Well, I think one major thing that makes people unhappy at work is a lack of recognition. When you put in a lot of effort, but your boss or colleagues never acknowledge it, it can feel really discouraging. Another factor is poor work-life balance. For example, if you're constantly expected to answer emails late at night or work weekends, it drains your energy and leaves no time for family or hobbies. Both of these can really kill your motivation over time.

4. Great. And finally, some people believe that working for a large company offers more advantages than working for a small company, while others prefer the opposite. What do you think? And why?

Well, I believe working for a small company offers more advantages. For one thing, employees often get to wear multiple hats and take on diverse responsibilities... which really accelerates skill development. In a large company, roles can be very narrow and specialized. Also, in a small company, your contributions are more visible. You can see the direct impact of your work on the business, which is very rewarding. So, for those reasons, I think small companies provide a better environment for growth and making a real difference.

1. Thank you for agreeing to participate. I'd like to ask you some questions about your online learning experiences. First, have you or someone you know ever taken an online course? If so, what was the subject?

Well, sure... Actually yes, I took an online course in data analysis last year. I chose it because I wanted to improve my analytical skills for work. The course was very well-structured, with clear video lectures and interactive quizzes. What really helped was the hands-on projects, which let me apply concepts in real-world scenarios. The instructor was engaging and responsive to questions. Overall, it was a valuable experience that boosted my confidence.

2. Thank you. Can you describe what you think are some of the advantages or disadvantages of an online course over an in-person course?

Okay, so online courses have the clear advantage of flexibility... you can learn anytime and anywhere, which is great for busy people. But on the other hand, a major disadvantage is the lack of personal interaction... you don't get that immediate feedback from the instructor, or the chance to collaborate with classmates in real time. In-person courses offer that, but they're less flexible. So, for example, I prefer in-person for discussion-based classes, but online works better for self-paced subjects. It's a trade-off.

3. Interesting. Online courses often let students work at their own pace. How do you feel about learning when there is no set class time?

Well... I actually really enjoy learning without a set class time. It gives me the flexibility to study when I'm most focused, like early in the morning. For me, this means I can pause and rewatch difficult lectures, which really helps with understanding complex topics. Also, I can adjust my schedule around work or other commitments. Without a fixed time, I feel less pressure and more in control of my learning pace. That said, it does require strong self-discipline to stay on track. Overall, I prefer this freedom.

4. Great. One of the concerns with online learning is online assessment, with some people believe that you cannot trust the results of an online test. What do you think about that issue?

Okay, so I understand why some people doubt online assessments, but I think they can be trusted. For example, many universities use proctoring software that monitors students through their cameras. Also, tests are often designed with random question pools and time limits, which make cheating harder. Additionally, some platforms use AI to detect suspicious behavior. In my personal experience, I've taken online exams that were just as rigorous as in-person ones. So overall, I'm confident that with proper safeguards and good test design, online test results are reliable.

You have signed up for a study run by a university research group that is investigating spending habits and budgeting. You will have a short video interview with one of the researchers. The researcher will ask you some questions.

1. Thank you for participating in this study. Today, I'd like to ask you some questions about your spending habits. First, can you tell me about a recent purchase you or someone in your family made, and why you decided to buy it?

Okay... well, I'd like to talk about a recent purchase my mom made. Actually, she bought a new air fryer last month. You see, our old oven was taking too long to heat up and using a lot of electricity. So, we decided to get an air fryer because it's faster, more energy-efficient, and healthier for cooking. My mom was especially excited about making crispy fries with less oil. It's been really convenient for our family, and we use it almost every day now.

2. I see. When you make a purchase, do you usually plan ahead or do you buy things spontaneously? Why?

Well, I usually plan ahead when making purchases, especially for big-ticket items. For example, before buying a new laptop, I research different models, compare prices, and wait for sales. This helps me avoid overspending and ensures I get the best value. However, for small things like snacks or a coffee, I can be more spontaneous. But overall, planning gives me peace of mind because I feel in control of my finances.

3. Interesting. Some people believe that creating a monthly or weekly budget is essential for managing finances effectively. When budgeting your time or money for your next purchase, which is more important, quality for the money or spending less overall, why?

Okay... for me when budgeting, quality for the money is definitely more important than just spending less overall. I say this because buying something cheap that breaks quickly actually ends up costing more in the long run. For example, I once bought a very inexpensive backpack and it fell apart within two months. Then I had to buy another one. So, spending a bit more upfront for better quality saves me from replacing items constantly. It's about value, not just the lowest price, and that's how I manage my finances effectively.

4. Good points. For my final question, I'd like to ask about using apps or online tools for managing spending habits. Do you think people will increasingly rely on financial apps and tools to manage their money, or will people prefer to hire personal financial managers? Explain your thoughts.

Well... I definitely think people will increasingly rely on financial apps rather than hiring personal managers. Apps are much more convenient and affordable... you can track your spending instantly on your phone anytime. For example, apps like Mint or Parmis categorize your expenses and send alerts when you're overspending. In contrast, personal managers are expensive and not accessible to everyone. Plus, apps give you real-time control and privacy over your finances. So for most people, the convenience and low cost of apps will make them the preferred choice for managing money.

You have agreed to participate in a research study about people's daily routines. You will have a short online interview with a researcher. The researcher will ask you some questions.

1. Thank you for taking the time to speak with me. I'd like to ask you some questions about your daily routines. First, do you usually follow a strict daily routine? or is yours flexible?

Well, actually... I'd say my daily routine is pretty flexible. I mean, I have a general structure, like waking up around the same time each day and having meals at set hours, but I don't stick to a rigid schedule. For instance, my work hours vary, so I might start earlier some days and take breaks when I need to. This flexibility really helps me adapt to unexpected tasks or personal commitments, and it keeps me from feeling stressed. So overall, I prefer a loose routine that allows for spontaneity.

2. Understood. Now can you describe a typical day for you? What are some activities you typically do in the morning or in the afternoon?

Okay... well, a typical day for me starts pretty early. In the morning, I usually wake up around seven, then I have a light breakfast and go for a short jog. After that, I head to work, where I spend most of my morning in meetings or checking emails. In the afternoon, I focus on more independent tasks, like writing reports or planning projects. Around five, I wrap up work and often relax by reading or watching a show. Then I have dinner and wind down before bed.

3. Gotcha! How do you manage your daily routine? Can you share an example of a time when you had to adjust your plans?

Well, I usually manage my daily routine by making a to-do list the night before... it helps me stay organized. For example, last week I had planned to study for an exam in the afternoon, but my friend suddenly needed help moving. So, I adjusted my plans by studying early in the morning instead. This flexibility worked out well because I still met my goal, and I was able to support my friend. So, I think being adaptable is key.

4. Very good. Last question. Some people believe that having a strict daily routine helps them be more productive and organized. While others think that freedom is key to handling life's unpredictability. Which approach do you think is more effective? And why?

Okay, I personally believe a strict daily routine is more effective. For me, it provides a clear structure that minimizes decision fatigue. For example, I always study from eight to ten in the morning, and that consistency helps me focus deeply without wasting time planning. While flexibility is valuable, a routine ensures I actually complete my most important tasks. It builds discipline, and once it's a habit, you can still adapt when something unexpected comes up. So, for productivity, a routine is key.

You have volunteered for a research study at your university about cultural festivals. You will have a short online interview with a researcher. The researcher will ask you some questions.

1. I'd like to ask you some questions about cultural festivals. First, cultural festivals are events that celebrate traditions like food, music, art, or clothing from a certain culture. Have you ever been to one, or would you like to go to one? Why?

Yes, several — they're a big part of life in Iran. The one I'd describe is Chaharshanbe Suri, sometimes translated as the Scarlet Wednesday. It's held on the eve of the last Wednesday of the year, and it comes from ancient Zoroastrian tradition. People light fires in the street and jump over them, and the whole neighbourhood comes out. The main reason I love it is the atmosphere — everyone is outside at the same time, all ages, and the city feels completely different. For example, you know your neighbours that night in a way you don't the rest of the year. So overall, it's my favourite.

2. Thank you. If you were to go to a cultural festival, what would you like to see or do there?

Two things mainly. First, I'd want the shared, physical part of it — with Chaharshanbe Suri that's the fires, the music and the street being full of people. It isn't something you watch; you take part in it. And second, the food, always — for me the food is where a culture is most concentrated. But honestly, what I'd really want is to spend the time with the people I love, or at a big national gathering. For example, I'd love to celebrate somewhere like Pasargadae, the way ancient Iranians did. So overall: fire, food, and good company.

3. Interesting, if you were to participate in a cultural festival for your own culture, what would you want to share with other people, and why?

Food, first of all — traditional Iranian dishes like sabzi polo ba mahi, and the drinks that go with them. And the Haft-Seen table, which is what we set for Nowruz; each item on it means something, so it explains the culture while you're looking at it. The main reason I'd choose food and the table is that they're the parts people can experience rather than be told about. For example, you understand more about a culture from one shared meal than from an explanation. So overall, I'd share the table and the meal, because that's how we keep our own roots alive too.

4. Great. Some people think cultural festivals are mainly just for fun, while others think that they serve an important purpose, like helping to keep traditions alive. What do you think?

I'd say they serve a real purpose, and Yalda is the clearest example. It's the longest night of the year, at the end of autumn, and we spend it together as a family. The older people use it to teach us about appreciating time and about staying together — the whole symbolism is that if we get through the darkness together, it passes more easily. That's not entertainment, that's a lesson being handed down. For example, I learned it as a child without anyone lecturing me. So overall, the fun is what gets people in the room; the meaning is why it survives.

You have volunteered for a research study about people's experiences with technology in daily life. You will have a short online interview with a researcher. The researcher will ask you some questions.

1. Thank you for signing up for the study. I'd like to ask you some questions about your experiences with technology and daily life. First, how important is technology in your day-to-day activities?

Well, I'd say technology is extremely important in my daily life. Actually, I use it for almost everything, from waking up with my phone alarm to checking emails and messages throughout the day. For example, I rely on my laptop for work, especially for video meetings and writing reports. Also, I use apps for banking, ordering food, and even tracking my fitness. Without technology, simple tasks would take much longer, so it really helps me stay organized and efficient.

2. Noted. Thank you. Have you ever felt frustrated while using technology? What happened?

Well, sure, I've definitely felt frustrated with technology. For example, last semester, my laptop suddenly froze while I was finishing a major essay due in two hours. I hadn't saved the latest changes, so I panicked. I tried restarting it, but it took forever to boot up. Eventually, I lost about an hour of work. It was really stressful because I had to rewrite everything quickly. That experience taught me to save my work constantly and use cloud backups. So yeah, technology can be annoying sometimes, but it's manageable with good habits.

3. Fair enough. Next question. Some people believe technology will replace many jobs, while others think it will create more opportunities. What is your opinion and why?

Well, I believe technology will both replace some jobs and create new opportunities. For instance, automation has eliminated many manufacturing roles, but it's also given rise to entirely new fields like data science and app development. In my view, the key is adaptability. People who learn digital skills can thrive in this changing landscape, while those who resist might struggle. So, overall, I think the net effect is positive, as long as we focus on education and retraining.

4. Okay, last question. Some people believe that reliance on technology is reducing our ability to think independently and solve problems. Do you agree or disagree with this belief? Why or why not?

Okay, I actually disagree with that belief. I think technology can enhance our problem-solving skills rather than diminish them. For example, when I use a GPS app, I still need to make decisions about the best route based on traffic updates and my own preferences. Similarly, research tools online require me to evaluate sources critically. Technology provides us with more information, but we still have to analyze, interpret, and apply that information independently. So, it's not reducing our ability to think; it's giving us more complex problems to solve.

You received an email from your university inviting you to join a research study about music preferences. You have scheduled a short online interview with a researcher to answer a few questions.

1. Thank you for agreeing to participate, I'd like to ask you some questions about your music preferences. First, how often do you listen to music? Do you listen daily, weekly or less often?

Oh, I definitely listen to music every single day. It's actually a really important part of my routine. I usually put on some music while I'm commuting to work or studying. It helps me focus and stay motivated. I have playlists for different moods, like upbeat pop for the morning and something more relaxing in the evening. Honestly, I can't imagine a day without it.

2. Thank you. What genres or types of music do you usually enjoy listening to? For example, do you prefer classical, rock or jazz music? Get details to explain your answer.

Well, I really enjoy listening to jazz music the most. I find it incredibly relaxing and expressive... especially when I'm studying or winding down after a long day. For example, I love artists like Miles Davis and John Coltrane because their improvisations create a unique atmosphere every time. Unlike classical music which feels too structured for me, jazz offers this wonderful balance between spontaneity and melody. It just makes me feel calm and focused, so it's my go-to genre.

3. Interesting. Can you tell me about a concert or live music event you would like to attend? Why would you make that particular choice?

Well, actually, I'd really love to attend a Taylor Swift concert. I've been a fan of her music for years, and her live performances are known for being incredibly energetic and theatrical. For example, I've seen videos of her Eras Tour, where she performs songs from different albums with stunning visuals and costume changes. It's not just about the music, but the whole experience... connecting with thousands of other fans, singing along to every word. That kind of shared energy and emotion would be unforgettable, so I'd choose that concert without hesitation.

4. Great. Some people believe that music can have a powerful effect on our emotions and moods. Do you agree or disagree with this viewpoint? Why?

Okay... I definitely agree that music has a powerful effect on our emotions. For example, when I hear a fast-paced, upbeat song, I instantly feel more energetic and motivated. On the other hand, a slow, melancholic piece can make me feel reflective or even a bit sad. This happens because music triggers certain areas in our brain that process feelings. So yeah, I think music is a really strong tool for influencing mood.

As part of a university project, you have agreed to take part in a short research interview about public transportation. A graduate student conducting the research will ask you some questions online.

1. Thank you for agreeing to participate. I'd like to ask you some questions about public transportation. First, how often do you use public transportation?

Well, I actually use public transportation quite frequently, probably three or four times a week. I take the bus to get to my university, since parking there is really expensive and limited. It's also a great way to save money on gas. On weekends, I sometimes use the subway to meet friends downtown because it's faster than driving through traffic. Overall, it's a convenient and cost-effective option for me.

2. Thank you. Can you describe any benefits or disadvantages you might experience from using public transportation?

Well... actually, I think public transportation has several benefits. For me, the biggest advantage is definitely saving money on gas and parking fees. Also, I can use my commute time productively, like reading or catching up on emails. However, there are disadvantages too... sometimes buses or trains run late, which can be really frustrating. Also, during rush hour it gets very crowded and uncomfortable. But overall, I'd say the benefits outweigh the drawbacks for me.

3. Interesting. Would you consider moving in order to have better access to public transportation? Why? or Why not?

Well... actually, I would definitely consider moving for better access to public transportation. For me, convenience is key. If I lived in an area where I had to drive everywhere, it would take more time and cause more stress. But with good public transit, I could read or relax during my commute instead of sitting in traffic. Plus, it's more environmentally friendly and saves money on gas and parking. So yes, having that option would be a big factor in my decision to move.

4. Great. Some people believe that cities should invest more in public transportation to reduce traffic congestion and reduce commuting time and pollution. do you agree or disagree with this idea? Why?

Well, I definitely agree that cities should invest more in public transportation. For one thing, it directly reduces traffic congestion because more people using buses or trains means fewer cars on the road. This also cuts down commuting time significantly since public transit can use dedicated lanes. Additionally, it lowers pollution levels, which is crucial for improving air quality in crowded urban areas. So, overall, this investment is a practical and effective solution for creating more sustainable and livable cities.

You received an email from your university inviting you to join a research study about personal finance. You have scheduled a short online interview with a researcher to answer a few questions.

1. Thank you for agreeing to participate. I'd like to ask you some questions about your personal finance habits. First, how often do you review your money management, for example tracking your expenses? or budgeting? Do you do this weekly, monthly, or less often?

Okay... I actually review my money management quite regularly, probably on a weekly basis. Every Sunday evening, I take about ten minutes to track my expenses using a simple spreadsheet on my phone. I list everything I spent that week, like groceries, transportation, and dining out. This habit helps me stay aware of where my money goes and makes budgeting much easier. I find that doing it weekly prevents overspending and keeps me on track with my financial goals. So yeah, weekly reviews work best for me.

2. Thank you. Can you describe one or two methods you or someone you know uses to manage their finances? for example do you use budgeting apps or keep a written record?

Okay, well, I personally use a budgeting app, and it's been really helpful for me. I track all my expenses, like groceries and rent, and the app automatically categorizes them. This way, I can see exactly where my money goes each month. It also sets spending limits, which keeps me from overspending. For bigger goals, like saving for a trip, I set up a separate savings goal within the app. It's convenient because everything is on my phone, so I can check my finances anytime. I find it much easier than keeping a written record.

3. Interesting. Can you tell me about a financial goal you achieved recently? What motivated you to achieve this goal?

Okay... well, a recent financial goal I achieved was saving up enough to take a trip to Japan. I was motivated by a strong desire to experience the culture and see the historic temples and gardens firsthand. To reach my goal, I cut back on eating out and started packing my lunch every day. It was challenging at first, but seeing my savings grow kept me going. Reaching that target felt incredibly rewarding, and the trip itself was amazing.

4. Great. Some people believe that fiscal responsibility education should be mandatory in schools and it helps students to function effectively as adults. Do you agree or disagree with this idea? why?

Well, I definitely agree that fiscal responsibility education should be mandatory in schools. You know, many young adults graduate without basic skills like budgeting or understanding credit card interest, and that can lead to serious financial problems later. For example, if students learn how to create a monthly budget or save for emergencies early on, they'll be much better prepared to handle rent, bills, and unexpected expenses as adults. It's a practical life skill that directly helps people function effectively, so I think it's essential.

You have volunteered for a research study about people's experiences with commuting. You will have a short online interview with a researcher. The researcher will ask you some questions.

1. Thank you for your willingness to participate today. I'd like to ask you some questions about your experiences with commuting. First, what kinds of places do you usually go to during the week? And how do you get there?

Okay, well... during the week, I usually go to my university campus for classes and the library for studying. I also visit a nearby grocery store and sometimes a coffee shop to meet friends. To get there, I mostly take the bus, since it's convenient and affordable. On days when I'm running late, I use a ride-sharing service like Uber. Walking is also an option for shorter distances, like to the grocery store. So, public transport and walking are my main ways of getting around.

2. Got it. Can you describe how someone in your family or a friend, usually travels to work or school? how much time does it take? And what transportation does the person use?

Well, sure... my friend Sarah takes the subway to work every day. She lives in the city center, and her office is about twenty minutes away by train. She usually leaves home around eight, walks five minutes to the station, and then rides the subway directly. The whole trip takes about half an hour in total. She prefers it because it's reliable and she can read or listen to music during the commute. She says it's much better than driving in traffic.

3. Ok thanks. Next question. Some people believe that living close to work or school improves quality of life, while others think location doesn't matter much. What do you think? and why?

Well, I definitely believe living close to work or school improves quality of life. For me, it reduces commuting stress and saves time. I used to commute an hour each way, and it was exhausting. Now that I live nearby, I have more energy for hobbies and family. Plus, I save money on transportation. So, location really matters because it directly affects daily comfort and productivity.

4. Great. final question. Some people believe that employers should reimburse employees for their commuting costs, while others think that employees should pay for their own travel to work. Which do you agree with? and why?

Okay... I definitely think employers should reimburse commuting costs. For one thing, it's a fair way to support employees financially, especially for those who live far away due to high housing costs near the office. For example, a friend of mine spends over two hundred dollars a month on train tickets, and that really adds up. Also, covering these costs can boost morale and loyalty, making workers feel valued. Ultimately, if companies expect people to come into the office, they should help cover the travel expenses.

1. Thank you for agreeing to participate. I'd like to ask you some questions about hobbies. To begin, do you have a hobby or interest that you regularly spend time doing?

Okay, definitely. I'm really into photography, especially nature photography. I spend most weekends hiking with my camera, capturing landscapes and wildlife. It's a great way to relax, and it pushes me to notice small details, like light and texture. I also enjoy editing the photos later, which feels creative. So it's not just a hobby, it's a way for me to appreciate the outdoors more.

2. Thank you. If you were to select a new hobby, what would you choose and why?

Okay... if I were to select a new hobby, I'd choose photography. The main reason is that it encourages me to notice details I usually overlook, like light and texture, which helps me appreciate everyday moments more. Also, photography is very accessible since most people have a smartphone, so I could start right away without buying expensive equipment. It's a creative outlet that combines technology with artistry. I think it would be both relaxing and rewarding to capture memories and share them with friends and family.

3. Interesting. Now tell me what might prevent you from starting this new pastime.

Okay, well... the biggest thing might be finding the time. I'm pretty busy with work and studies, so squeezing in a new hobby could be tough. Also, cost is a concern... if it requires a lot of equipment or lessons, I'd have to budget carefully. But I think if I really commit and start small, I can overcome these obstacles.

4. Great. Some people believe it is better to have one interest outside of work or school that you dedicate yourself to rather than multiple smaller ones. What do you think about that and why?

Okay... I actually believe it's better to focus on one main interest outside of work or school. For me, dedicating yourself deeply to one hobby allows you to truly master it, which brings a sense of accomplishment and relaxation. For example, if you spend all your free time on photography, you'll improve your skills and produce meaningful work. In contrast, juggling multiple small interests can leave you feeling scattered and less fulfilled. So, I think depth over breadth is more rewarding for personal growth.

As part of a university project, you have agreed to take part in a short research interview about health and wellness habits. A graduate student conducting the research will ask you some questions online.

1. Thank you for agreeing to participate. I'd like to ask you some questions about your health and wellness habits. First, do you have any specific routines or practices you use to maintain your physical well-being? If so, what are they?

Okay... well, I definitely have a few routines I stick to for my physical health. First, I make sure to exercise at least four times a week... usually a mix of jogging and some light strength training. I also pay close attention to my diet... I try to eat plenty of vegetables and drink a lot of water throughout the day. And finally, I prioritize getting around seven to eight hours of sleep each night... that really helps me feel energized and focused. So yeah, those three things are key for me.

2. Thank you. Can you describe any dietary choices or habits that you follow to stay healthy? Give details to explain your answer.

Well, sure... I try to follow a few simple habits to stay healthy. For example, I make sure to include a lot of vegetables in my meals, like spinach and broccoli, because they're packed with vitamins. I also drink plenty of water throughout the day, around eight glasses, to stay hydrated. Additionally, I limit processed foods and sugary snacks, opting instead for fruits like apples or berries when I want something sweet. These choices help me maintain my energy and focus, especially during busy days.

3. Interesting. If you could make one significant change to your diet or exercise routine to stay healthy, what would it be? Why would you make that particular choice?

Well... if I could make one significant change to stay healthy, I would definitely start strength training twice a week. I already do cardio, but I've realized that building muscle is crucial for long-term health. You know, it boosts metabolism and strengthens bones as we age. I think this choice is important because... it addresses a common weakness in many people's routines. Plus, it doesn't require drastic diet changes, just a small time commitment. So overall, adding strength training would really balance out my fitness routine and help me stay healthy in the long run.

4. Great. Some people believe that mental health is just as important as physical health, and should be given equal attention. Do you agree or disagree with this viewpoint? Why?

Well, I completely agree that mental health is just as important as physical health. For one thing, mental well-being directly affects our physical state... like when someone's stressed, they might get headaches or feel tired all the time. Also, ignoring mental health can lead to serious issues like depression or anxiety, which are just as debilitating as physical illnesses. So, giving equal attention to both makes sense because they're deeply connected... and treating them separately doesn't reflect how we actually experience health in our daily lives.

Here are some tips that might help you along your journey:

For Task 1:

THE PROTOCOL — memorise these five moves

① **BEFORE the audio: the reset breath.** Exhale fully through your mouth. Drop your shoulders. Unclench your jaw (let your teeth come apart, tongue soft). This takes 2 seconds and reclaims measurable working memory. Do it before **every single** sentence, especially 5, 6 and 7.

② **DURING the audio: chunk to 3, don't store 13.** Every English sentence breaks into 2–4 **intonation groups** — the speaker's voice tells you where. Listen for the melody, not the words.

"The master control panel / is used to manage / all studio equipment." That is **3 chunks**, not 8 words. Three fits. Eight does not.

Feel the rhythm as three beats: **DA-da-da-DA / da-da-da-DA-da / DA-DA-da-DA**. Rhythm memory is far more durable than word memory, and once you have the rhythm the words fall back into it.

③ **AT the beep: start within half a second.** This is non-negotiable and it is where most of your loss is. Every second you hesitate, the trace decays. **Do not wait until you "have it all."** Start on the first chunk and trust that chunk 2 and 3 will arrive — they usually do, because speaking chunk 1 cues chunk 2. Hesitating to "check" the sentence is what deletes it.

Your inner cue at the beep: **"GO."** Not "what was it?" — **"GO."**

④ **NEVER restart.** A restart costs you more than a wrong word. One word wrong on a long sentence is still a 3.5–4. A restart plus a stumble is a 2.5. If you get a word wrong, **keep going and let it be wrong.** If a word is completely gone, **substitute any plausible word of the same type** and keep the sentence frame intact. Partial credit beats silence, and silence in a 12-second window is very expensive.

forgot "equipment" → say "all studio equipment" anyway; if truly gone, "all studio machines." Keep moving.

⑤ **Speak SLOWER than the speaker.** You have 12 seconds for a 12–14 word sentence. That is generous. Rushing is what makes you drop -s and swallow at. Aim to finish at about **10 of the 12 seconds**, with every ending audible. Clear and one-word-wrong scores higher than fast and mumbled.

The -s / at / the problem — your specific leak

This is a first-language interference issue, not carelessness. Persian has no articles and marks plurals differently, so under pressure your brain drops exactly these. Two fixes:

Fix A — over-articulate final consonants. For today only, deliberately *exaggerate* every final -s, -z, -t, -d, -ed. Feel the tongue touch. On test day it will come out as *normal* clarity rather than swallowed. It will feel silly at home. Do it anyway.

Drill (say each 3× with an audible ending):

He wants the books. · She lives at the corner. · The classes start at nine. · It depends on the students' needs. · My sister works at a lab and studies at night.

Fix B — the "small words carry the melody" reframe. Stop thinking of at / in / on / the / a as small unimportant words. In the rhythm of the sentence they are the *unstressed beats* — if you delete them, the rhythm breaks and the AI hears the break. Listen for the sentence's rhythm (move @) and the small words come along automatically, because they are part of the beat.

Today's drill (Block A, 90 min)

1. Get any English audio with clear speech — a podcast, an audiobook, a news clip, ETS practice sentences, the sentences in the pocket guide you uploaded.
2. Play **one sentence once**. Pause. Do the reset breath. Repeat it out loud, recording yourself.
3. Play it again and compare. Mark **only two things**: (a) words dropped, (b) endings swallowed.
4. Every 10 sentences, do one deliberately with a 12-second timer.
5. Last 20 minutes: do 15 sentences **back to back with no review**, to simulate test pressure.

Do not chase 100% accuracy. Chase **"started immediately, never restarted, endings audible."**

For Task 2:

PART 3 — THE 45-SECOND INTERVIEW ENGINE

Stop memorising answers. Memorise ONE frame and ONE story bank.

You already discovered the truth: memorised sample answers evaporate in the test room. They evaporate because a memorised paragraph is a single fragile thread — drop one word and the whole thing collapses. What does *not* evaporate is (a) a movement pattern you have repeated 40 times, and (b) real things that happened to you.

The frame — three moves, always the same

Move	Seconds	What you say
1 · ANSWER	0–8	Opener + your direct position. No warm-up, no "let me think about this."
2 · REASON + EXAMPLE	8–30	One reason, then "For example," and one <i>concrete, personal, specific</i> detail. This is where the score lives.
3 · TIE-BACK	30–42	"So overall / So for me, ..." — one sentence restating the position in different words. Then stop .

Land your finish around **40–43 seconds**. Finishing cleanly at 42 scores better than being cut off mid-word at 45. A clean ending signals control.

Your six openers — rotate them, never repeat one twice in a set

These buy you 3 seconds of thinking time while sounding natural. Say them warmly, like a real conversation.

1. "Honestly, for me, ..."
2. "That's a good question. I'd say ..."
3. "Well, personally, ..."
4. "Actually, yes — ..." / "Actually, not really. ..."
5. "Um, I think it depends, but overall ..."
6. "Right — so, for me, ..."

Your seven connectors — that is all you need

First of all, · For example, · The main reason is that · On the other hand, · What I mean is, · So overall, · That said,

Do not use *moreover, furthermore, nevertheless, in conclusion*. They sound memorised and they are not how people speak in an interview. Natural connectors score higher than fancy ones in this task.

The four question types — the whole task, decoded

Almost every real set follows this exact shape. Learn four responses, not 132.

Q Type	What they want	Your default move
1 Personal recall	A memory / a habit	Pick one story from your bank. Give the <i>when, who, what happened</i> . Do not list.
2 Preference / reaction	Your feelings, your everyday behaviour	State the preference, then say why it suits your personality . Your introversion is a gift here — it explains half your preferences.
3 Opinion + support	Take a side and justify	Pick a side in the first 5 seconds . Do not balance. One reason + one example beats two vague reasons.
4 Policy / prediction	Speculate about the future or a rule	Use the "Yes-but" shape: <i>"I think yes — mainly because X. That said, the risk is Y. So overall I'd say Z."</i> This one shape answers every Q4 in the entire question bank.

Q4 UNIVERSAL PATTERN — memorise this, it is the highest-value 40 words in the file

"I'd say yes / I don't think so — and the main reason is [ONE reason]. For example, [one concrete thing]. That said, [one honest drawback]. So overall, I think [restate position] as long as [one condition]."

Every prediction question ("will theatres disappear", "will AI design our routines", "should cities invest more", "will online replace in-person") fits this. If you learn nothing else from this pamphlet, learn this.

PART 4 — YOUR CORE STORY BANK

These are **your** real details, cleaned up into fluent English. Ten of them cover almost every question in the bank. Read them aloud until they are automatic. In the test, you are not recalling an answer — you are picking a card from this deck and bending it to the question.

S1 • The startup. "I co-founded an app called ... with a partner, and right now my goal is to scale it and get it funded."

S2 • Germany. "I got an admission offer from a top business school in Germany — that's my biggest recent achievement, and it took me months of applications and paperwork."

S3 • Work. "I've worked for years in international sales, procurement and business development, dealing with suppliers and clients in different countries."

S4 • German at B2. "I'm taking online German classes right now and preparing for an exam — I'm at B2 and honestly it's hard."

S5 • Obstacles in Iran. "Living in Iran, the obstacles are real — internet shutdowns, the cost of a VPN, inflation, and the war last year. So I've had to learn to work around things instead of waiting for conditions to be perfect."

S6 • The piano. "I play piano, and I mostly listen to classical — Bach and Chopin. When I sit down and play, I feel completely detached from the noise of daily life."

S7 • Metal → classical. "When I was younger I was really into rock and metal — the heavy lyrics matched my mood at that age. Now I've moved towards classical and old traditional Iranian music. It's more nostalgic."

S8 • Introvert. "I'm quite introverted, so I keep a small circle. I'd rather spend real time with a few people I already love than meet a lot of new ones."

S9 • The sick friend. "One night around eleven I was sick and I called a friend. She came over, cooked for me, and stayed until I fell asleep — her mother even sent food. Later she ended up in hospital and I skipped my piano class to be with her. That taught me that in friendship, sacrifice comes before everything."

S10 • The Canada reunion. "Last month my uncle's family came back from Canada after ten years, for my little cousin's fifth birthday. The whole family got together, we had a party, there was a huge amount of food. He'd never been to Iran before and he bonded with everyone — afterwards he kept asking his mum to bring him back to our house."

S11 • The cutting board. "I once bought a cheap cutting board — bad wood, no finish. I had to replace it three times, and in the end I'd spent more than a good steel one would have cost. I still regret it."

S12 • The hacked laptop. "My laptop got hacked and I lost a lot of data. It cost me a lot and I had to reinstall Windows completely. Most of my technology frustrations come from that laptop."

S13 • Mum's surgery. "My sister needed eye surgery — LASIK eye surgery — and I was studying at the same time. I spent days researching doctors, checking their pages and booking appointments, while still doing my own work. In the end she started sending me pre-made meals so I'd spend less time cooking."

S14 • Attack on Titan. "I once watched Attack on Titan day and night. I genuinely couldn't stop — I was late to work every morning for a week because I'd been up all night."

S15 • The Excel file. "I've kept a detailed financial spreadsheet for three years now, with my own categories. At the end of each month and each year I use it to see exactly where the money went and to plan the next period."

S16 • Badminton. "A friend and I reserved a badminton court for almost two years and trained with a really good coach. I loved it. I stopped because I wanted to play at a professional level and realised I wasn't going to get there, and I lost confidence."

S17 • Yalda. "We celebrate Yalda, the longest night of the year, at the end of autumn. The older people in the family use it to teach us about appreciating time and staying together — the whole symbolism is that if we're together, the darkness passes more easily."

S18 • Nowruz. "For Nowruz the whole family goes to my grandmother's house. She cooks, she gives everyone presents, and we set the Haft-Seen table. Younger Iranians actually care about it more now, not less — it's our root."

S19 • Deleted Instagram. "I deleted Instagram. It gave me anxiety — this constant sense that everyone else had a better life — and it destroyed my attention span. I use Telegram and WhatsApp for people and YouTube for learning."

S20 • Cutting sugar. "I cut out sugar and processed food and moved towards real, whole food. It made a difference to my energy, my mood and my hormones. I want to still be healthy when I'm old, so I take it seriously now."

How to use the bank under pressure: when a question lands and your mind blanks, do not search for an answer — **scan the deck.** "Goals? → S1/S2. Friendship? → S9. Technology? → S12. Culture? → S17/S18. Money? → S11/S15." One card, then the three-move frame. This is what replaces memorising.